THE MAGNET AND ITS POLES – 5 min

Time required

5 minutes

Equipment

- 2 × Small red/green magnets

Objective of Experiment No. 1

In this experiment, the interaction between two magnets will be observed.

Description of the experiment

- Hold the two elements, one in the left hand and the other in the right hand.
- Bring the poles of the two elements close together, holding them firmly with your fingers to perceive their behavior (see STEP 1).
- Repeat the operation by flipping one of the two elements to its opposite pole: if it was N before, now try S, or vice versa (see STEP 2).

Final observations

In this simple experiment, it was observed that in one case the two magnets attract each other, while in the other they repel each other. This depends on which poles are facing each other. By observing the letters marked on each magnet, it is clear that like poles repel each other, whereas opposite poles attract each other.

Questions for the teacher

1. How do magnets behave if, before being brought close together, they are heated so that their temperature increases by 10°C each?
2. If the magnets are arranged parallel to each other, with the same poles side by side, what happens when they are brought closer?